

PREMIUM

Pre-Departure Checklist

From visa confirmed to landing in Canada

2-4 weeks before departure

- Confirm your visa/entry status - check your passport for a visa counterfoil, or confirm your eTA-linked status if that applies to you instead
- Check your passport's remaining validity against your travel dates
- Confirm flights and accommodation
- Arrange travel insurance, including medical cover - Canada's public healthcare isn't available to most visitors
- Notify your bank/card providers of your travel dates and destination

The week before

- Save or print: passport photo page, visa/entry confirmation, flight itinerary, accommodation confirmation, and any Letter of Invitation
- Share your itinerary and emergency contacts with someone at home
- Check US transit requirements separately if your routing passes through the US

Day of travel

- Arrive at the airport with sufficient buffer time for an international departure
- Keep your passport and any printed documents in your hand luggage

At the Canadian border

Arriving with a visa doesn't automatically grant entry - a Canada Border Services Agency (CBSA) officer makes the final decision at the port of entry, and can ask questions consistent with your application. This is routine, not a sign of a problem.

- Be ready to briefly restate your purpose of visit and length of stay, consistent with your application
- Your authorized stay is decided by the CBSA officer at entry (recorded in your passport or your electronic entry record) - it can be shorter than your visa's overall validity
- Keep a note of your entry date and the latest date you must leave by, or apply for an extension (Visitor Record) before that date if you need longer